

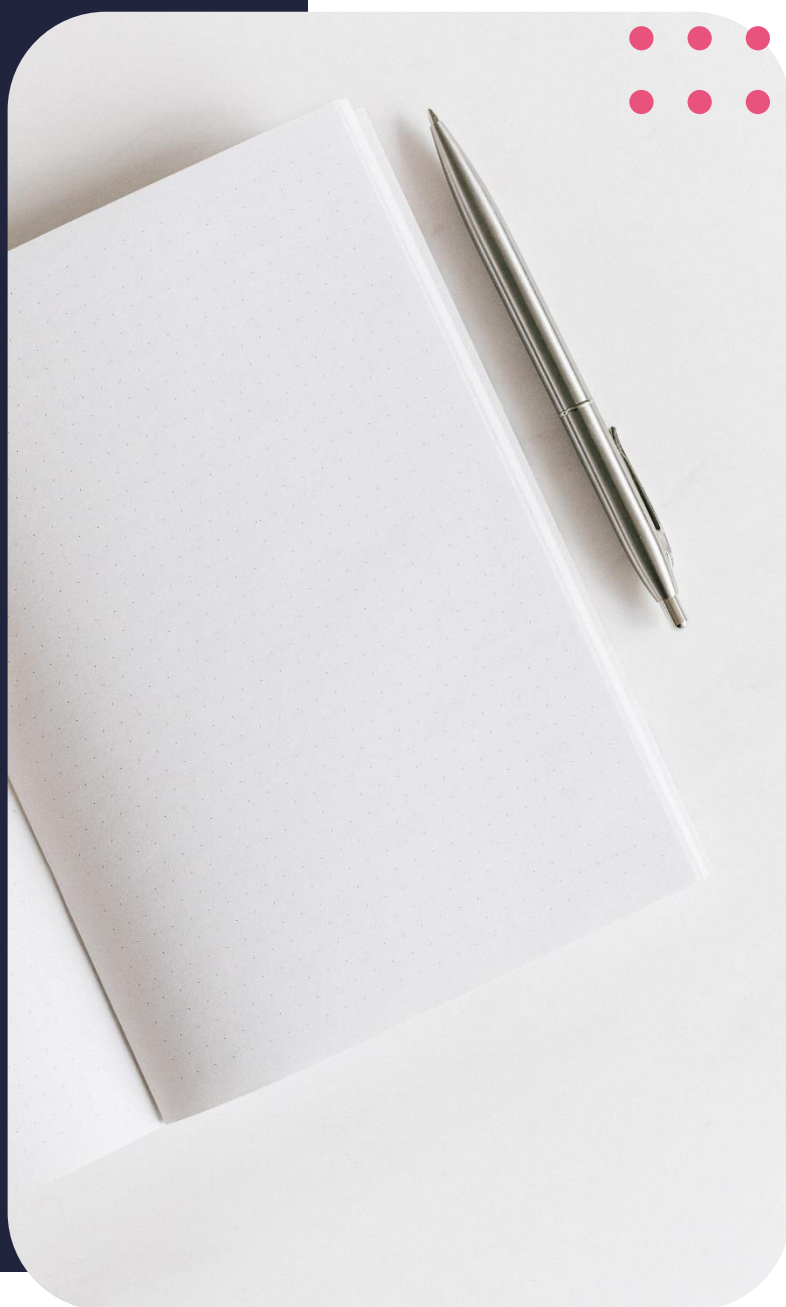
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Master Communication



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Lesson 9 Objectives

- Why does communication matter?
- Key communication tools
- Present information effectively

Lesson Introduction

Communication is all around us. It happens when we speak, when we listen, and when we look around us. Communication is the key competency for any leader or manager to master. Not only professionally but in your personal life as well. Communication is what connects us to each other and what allows us to better understand those around us.

Ernest Hemingway said: "When people talk, listen completely. Most people never listen".

Key Reading Materials

- <https://www.inc.com/jessica-stillman/7-tips-to-give-better-feedback.html>
- <https://www.15five.com/blog/9-ways-to-give-effective-employee-feedback/>
- <https://www.vyond.com/resources/tips-to-help-you-improve-your-presentation-skills/>
- <https://smallbusiness.chron.com/coach-employee-communicate-better-16035.html>

Self-Assessment: Company Culture

Test your communication: <https://www.activia.co.uk/communication-skills-test>

Tips to communicate better



According to (Healthy Relationships, 2018), for healthier and better communication the following can be applied in a practical manner.

Find the right time

Look for the correct opportunity to speak to someone or address an issue. For example, you can pull an employee aside to speak to him or her vs speaking to them publicly.

Talk face-to-face

It can be a lot more effective to speak to someone in person vs on the phone or over email. You can better see the demeanour of the person; see how they're taking the information and if they need more support or time.

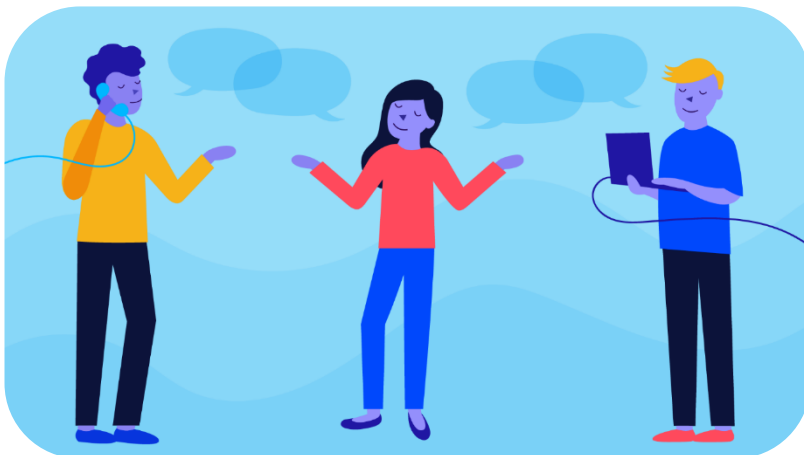
Don't attack the person

Avoid being harsh or too direct as this can cause the other person to shut down and not want to communicate. You can be honest in a tactful way that leaves both parties better off.

Check your body language

Try to be open and relaxed when you talk to someone. When you cross your arms or you're turned away from the person you can cause a bad impression and negatively impact the relationship with the person.

How to communicate when you're angry



Stop

Don't address the person or issue when you're angry. Walk away and calm down before you react. Take a breath or take a walk to clear your mind and get rid of the stress of the issue.

Think

Think of what you want to say and how you want to say it. Also, think of the outcome that will result from your words. You don't want to say something that will permanently impact your work relationships.

Talk

When you speak, be calm. Know what you want to say and give the other person time to speak and express themselves. Avoid only allowing yourself to speak and not the other person.

Listen

Allow the other person to speak and wait before you reply. Use the 5-10 second rule and wait before you reply. Also, think about what you want to reply before just speaking.

Steps to actively listen



According to (Grossman, 2017), these are the key steps to become an active listener.

1. Approach all interactions to learn

Think of everyone as a teacher. You can use each interaction as an opportunity to learn from the person or what way in which you interact. For example, when you don't like the person, you can learn to control your emotions. You can also learn to be more neutral and not be reactive.

2. Listen more than you speak

Avoid speaking over others and give everyone enough time to speak and think. This is a great way to start active listening when you're struggling.

3. Open and guide the conversation

You can open and guide the conversation by using open-ended questions. You can stay in control of the conversation while still being an active listener. This comes in handy in work situations.

4. Make sure to get the details

Ask direct, specific questions to help you understand and remember the details. For example: "Can you tell me more about...", "Why does the company do it this way?"

5. Summarize and ask questions

You can make sure if you understand what the other person is saying, and this gives the other person time to give feedback. This will help you build a better relationship with the person. For example: "If I understand you correctly, it involves...".

6. Encourage with positive feedback

If the speaker is struggling to express him or herself, you can encourage them. You can nod your head, smile and be patient so that they feel comfortable to speak.

7. **Listen for total meaning**

Don't only listen to the words that are being spoken. Also, look for body language cues and other emotions that help you understand what the person really means.

8. **Pay attention to your response**

Make sure that when you respond, you use respect as a key approach. Make sure you're open to what the other person says and that you're taking the time to respond correctly because you listened to the other party.

Top ways to improve your presentation skills



According to (Kim, 2020), these are some ways to improve your presentation skills.

Attend other presentations

Take the time to see how others are approaching the presentation. There are a lot of online options you can see that will help guide you.

Connect emotionally

Connect with the audience as much as you can. You can use your intro and outro to connect with those around you. You can tell a story related to yourself or an example of someone who inspires you. You can use quotes or anything that will evoke an emotion. You want people to engage as soon as you start to speak.

Work on pauses

Give the audience time to take in what you're saying. You need to take a breath after a long statement that gives you time to relax and for the audience to think.

Ask leading questions

You can ask the audience open-ended questions and questions where they can give their feedback on. The aim is to engage the audience and connect with them. They are more likely to listen when they can also give their input.

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